

Customer Experience: A Holistic Perspective

Abstract. In this conceptual note we argue that customer experience is holistic in nature and involves cognitive, affective, emotional, social and physical responses to the retailer. Prior work has treated the construct as a unidimensional satisfaction measure, which we consider too narrow for omnichannel contexts.

Verhoef et al. (2009, p. 32) explicitly define the construct as “a customer’s internal and subjective response”, and stress that the firm’s touchpoints shape it jointly. This definition remains influential in services marketing research.

Servicescape research similarly suggests that the physical environment is cognitively appraised before any affective response occurs, which explains why holistic in nature and involves remains a robust summary of the construct across contexts.